CRISTI MACARIA

UX/UI/AI & GRAPHIC & MOTION DESIGNER

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SOFTWARE

Figma · Adobe Photoshop · Adobe Illustrator · Adobe XD · Wix · Midjourney · Nano Banana · Dzine · Claude (Figma MCP) · ChatGPT

SKILLS & ABILITIES

- User-Centered Design
- AI-Assisted Design & Prototyping
- Wire-framing & Prototyping
- User Research & Usability Testing
- Information Architecture
- Interaction & Visual Design
- Responsive Design
- Accessibility & Inclusivity
- Design Systems & Handoff
- Branding & Visual Identity
- Typography & Layout Design
- Photo Editing & Retouching
- Collaboration & Communication

LANGUAGES

Romanian - Native
English - Fluent

EDUCATION

The Interaction Design Foundation
UX/UI Design & Design Thinking, 2023

Informal School of IT
IT Fundamentals & UX/UI Course, 2019

B.A., Physical Education & Sport
Babeș-Bolyai University, Cluj-Napoca, 2014

BEYOND WORK

-Cofounded Transylvanian Rippers, an annual extreme sports event, after petitioning the city for a skatepark.

-Volunteer skateboarding teacher.

-Volunteer, TIFF (Transilvania Int'l Film Festival).

SUMMARY

UX/UI and graphic designer with 5+ years of experience across product design, branding, and AI assisted design workflows. Started in visual and promotional content, grew into building full products end to end, and went on to lead design for a company running a live product while launching a new one in parallel, owning everything from daily assets to major campaigns and the website. Product-focused and ownership driven, currently deepening hands-on fluency with AI integrated workflows, pairing Figma AI, Claude (via the Figma MCP connector), and ChatGPT, to move faster, make better informed decisions, not for cutting corners on craft.

EXPERIENCE

UX/AI Designer

May 2026 – Present

Independent AI - Augmented Design Practice

- Deepened hands on fluency with AI-integrated design tools, pairing Figma's native AI features with Claude (via the Figma MCP connector) and ChatGPT to speed up exploration, prototyping, and decision-making.
- Used the Claude Figma connector to move faster between design and code, arriving at better informed decisions and quicker iteration cycles suited to high paced product environments.
- Kept full ownership of craft throughout, refining UI details and revalidating UX by hand, and reworking flows whenever a lower friction alternative surfaced, regardless of what an AI-assisted pass produced.

Lead Product Designer

Aug 2025 – May 2026 · 10 mos

Gecko Games

- Led end to end UX/UI design of a new mini-game platform from the ground up, establishing the visual language, typography, color system, layout/spacing standards, and cross-product consistency.
- Initiated and led a design review with the CEO and CTO, independently identifying cross platform consistency issues and proposing a unified visual direction adopted across the product suite.
- Conceived original feature concepts that were adopted and shipped as part of the platform's launch.
- Designed daily marketing assets, campaigns, icons, and email templates, and maintained the company website, keeping both visually consistent and up to date.

UX/UI & Graphics & MOTION Designer

Apr 2023 – Apr 2024 · 1 yr

DevHub

- Partnered with product managers and developers to align design work with project objectives, and defined the platform's visual identity, color palette, typography, and graphic elements.
- Built UI components, buttons, navigation, forms, icons, and optimized layouts for responsive performance across mobile, tablet, and desktop.
- Ran user research and usability testing, refining designs based on real feedback.
- Designed and maintained custom themes and characters to preserve brand identity over time.

UX/UI Designer

Apr 2021 – Apr 2024

InnovatorSpark · freelance, concurrent

- Built design systems from the ground up for consistency, scalability, and alignment with project goals, backed by QA passes to catch inconsistencies across platforms.
- Conducted user research to guide decisions, delivering responsive web designs and cohesive branding aligned with modern web standards.

Early Career

Nov 2019 – Apr 2023

Customer Service & Retail

– Self taught UX/UI through guided courses and hands on projects while supporting myself in customer service (Yardi, 6 mos) and retail roles, building the communication, problem-solving, and attention-to-detail habits now core to my design practice.